

Chapter 73-2

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In the dream, it was like an endless abyss, with her entire being continuously falling downward.

The entire world was pitch black.

Suddenly, the falling stopped.

A beam of light fell in a corner, dust particles dancing in the air. In the corner appeared a little girl with pigtails. Her head was buried in her knees, looking pitiful and alone.

Su Yao sat across from her, separated by a distance of several meters.

Su Yao felt her heart being wrenched with pain, brimming with indescribable sourness.

She reached out her hand, wanting to touch that child, but all she touched was empty air.

Yet she could clearly see that child.

After a while, the child lifted her head, but her face was a mass of pixels¹, completely obscuring her features.

Su Yao was confused and bewildered, asking sadly: "Who are you?"

The child opened and closed her mouth. Her mouth became visible, then her nose, her eyes—a face that looked very familiar.

It was a face she had seen during the day.

Her face was completely mismatched with her body, looking extremely incongruous.

But after seeing her, Su Yao just kept shedding tears.

The child spoke: "Why didn't you come find me?"

"I'm so sad." That tender, childish voice carried resentment, "I've had such a hard time."

"Mommy... what are you doing?"

"Are you my mommy? Come find me."

"....."

The childish voice became more and more miserable, more and more resentful. Just like it had appeared countless times in dreams before, she began to wail loudly.

During this, Sheng Qinglin's voice was also mixed in: "Yaoyao, look at little Zhuzi², she smiles so adorably."

"She looks like you, she'll definitely be beautiful when she grows up."

"Let's call her Qingzhu³, unbending and unbreakable, forever verdant⁴."

"She was born by you, of course she should take your surname."

"....."

Too many voices mixed together—she couldn't hear clearly at all.

At this moment, the Su family villa was in complete chaos.

The cause was that Sheng Yu woke up thirsty in the middle of the night and wanted water. She wanted to find a servant without disturbing her mother, but when going out the door she tripped and fell directly onto the carpet. Still not fully awake, she was in so much pain she wanted to cry, sniffing pitifully for a while.

Normally, her mother would have already woken up.

But when she drank water and returned to the room, quietly climbing onto the bed planning to continue sleeping, she heard her mother crying.

She pushed her mother, but there was no response.

Her mother's tears only fell more and more. Then her mother turned over, burying her entire head in the pillow, continuing to sob.

Sheng Yu was terrified and immediately burst into loud wails, startling everyone in the villa.

But the only person who wasn't awakened by the crying was Su Yao.

The family doctor summoned from abroad immediately held a consultation and discovered Su Yao had fallen into a deep nightmare.

In this situation, they couldn't rashly wake her. She was already mentally fragile—if they rashly woke her, who knew what serious consequences might occur.

The family doctor attempted to gently rouse her, but found it had no effect.

This startled everyone in the household.

Su Meiqi felt afraid in her heart. Then Sheng Yu cried beside her saying: "It must be because mommy was bullied by bad people today that she's crying."

"Bullied?" Su Zhe immediately interrogated: "By whom?"

Su Meiqi didn't let little Sheng Yu speak about this matter. Instead, she pulled her father into the study and laid out everything about encountering Xu Qingzhu at Minghui's entrance today. Then she asked in confusion: "What's her relationship with Auntie?"

Su Meiqi frowned: "She doesn't seem like Sheng Qinglin's niece, more like his daughter. And acting as if my aunt abandoned her."

Su Zhe: "....."

"You just saw Xu Qingzhu?" Su Zhe asked.

Su Meiqi nodded: "And her wife too."

"That good-for-nothing playboy?" Just mentioning her, Su Zhe's eyes were full of disdain.

Su Meiqi shook her head: "She's already reformed. Now she treats Sister Xu really well. The two of them are quite loving."

Su Zhe scoffed lightly, making no comment on this.

"First tell me, does Xu Qingzhu have a relationship with Auntie or not?" Su Meiqi asked again.

Su Zhe nodded: "She is your aunt's daughter."

Su Meiqi: "!"

"Then Auntie....." Su Meiqi paused, confused: "How did she suddenly remember?"

Su Zhe sighed: "She was triggered."

However, Su Zhe belatedly realized: "So Xu Qingzhu knew and came to condemn your aunt?"

"Can't really call it condemnation." Su Meiqi recalled her afternoon attitude, "She was very aggressive."

Su Zhe: "....."

"What gives her the right?" Su Zhe said angrily, "What does she even know?"

He originally wanted to curse, but thinking that back then Xu Qingzhu was just a baby who knew nothing, he had to let it go.

It just made that feeling of wanting to drag out the old Sheng couple and flog their corpses⁵ even stronger.

Every time Su Yao had an episode, Su Zhe wanted to flog their corpses once.

He even wanted to grab them by the collar and ask, "If your son whose bones aren't even cold yet could see this, do you think he could die with his eyes closed⁶?"

Driving his beloved to madness and snatching away his daughter to give her someone else's surname.

What idiotic parents.

Footnotes:

¹ Pixels/mosaic (马赛克): In Chinese internet culture, this term (literally "mosaic") refers to pixelation or blurring used to obscure images, similar to how faces are censored on TV.

² Little Zhuzi (小竹子): A nickname meaning "little bamboo." This is significant as it relates to Xu Qingzhu's name.

³ Qingzhu (青竹): Literally means "green/blue bamboo." This is Xu Qingzhu's given name.

⁴ Unbending and unbreakable, forever verdant (不屈不折,永远青翠): This describes the characteristics of bamboo in Chinese culture—resilience, strength, and evergreen vitality. Bamboo is one of the "Four Gentlemen" in Chinese art, symbolizing integrity and moral fortitude.

⁵ Flog their corpses (鞭尸): A Chinese expression meaning to severely criticize or condemn someone (especially the dead) for their past wrongs, derived from the historical practice of literally whipping corpses as punishment.

⁶ Die with his eyes closed (死得瞑目): A Chinese idiom meaning to die content or at peace, with no regrets. The literal image is of someone able to close their eyes peacefully in death. Used negatively here to suggest Sheng Qinglin would be unable to rest peacefully knowing what happened to his wife and daughter.